17.5 Gastroenteritis and Dehydration*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Mother says, "He has had diarrhea and vomiting since yesterday." **Objective** • Sunken eyes; dry mouth • Reduced skin turgor • Few wet diapers • 5% weight loss	**ACTUAL** Inadequate fluid volume related to diarrheal and emetic losses as evidenced by sunken eyes, dry mucosa and weight loss.	• Moist mouth and normal urine output within 8 hours.	• Assess how dehydrated he is. • Give oral rehydration solution in small, frequent amounts as prescribed. • Give IV fluids as ordered for severe dehydration. • Record intake, output and weight. • Keep breastfeeding going.	• Met once he is rehydrated.
Subjective • Mother says, "He has watery stools all day." **Objective** • Eight watery stools a day • Hyperactive bowel sounds	**ACTUAL** Impaired gastrointestinal motility related to intestinal infection as evidenced by frequent watery stools.	• Fewer stools within 48 hours.	• Record each stool. • Give zinc as prescribed. • Continue feeding suited to his age. • Teach hand hygiene.	• Achieved as stools become less frequent.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Frequent stools in the diaper	**RISK** Risk for impaired skin integrity as evidenced by risk factors: fecal contact with skin.	• Diaper-area skin stays intact.	• Change diapers promptly. • Clean gently and apply barrier cream. • Leave the skin open to the air when possible.	• Outcome reached if the skin stays intact.

*References for this care plan: [35], [38], [87], [135]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.